

Workflow Precedent Review

A CROSS-PRACTICE DECISION CANVAS - RUSSELL DUDEK

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Purpose: decide whether an AI-enabled workflow should remain matter-specific, become a practice pattern, enter cross-practice testing, become a maintained firm standard, be repaired, or retire. This is an operating metaphor, not legal authority.

1. FACT PATTERN

Attorney task, client objective, eligible users, matter conditions, consequence, current friction.

4. EVALUATION RECORD

Representative test set, task quality, citations, omissions, agreement, security, failure and release evidence.

2. KNOWLEDGE RECORD

Approved sources, provenance, taxonomy, access, privilege boundary, freshness, content owner.

5. ADOPTION AND OWNERSHIP

Practice sponsor, workflow insertion point, training, support, feedback, technical and content owners.

3. HUMAN AUTHORITY

AI role, required lawyer judgment, review checkpoint, escalation, override, prohibited action.

6. VALUE EVIDENCE

Observed effect on matter execution, attorney leverage, quality, client responsiveness, or economics.

PROPOSED TREATMENT

TREATMENT	WHY THIS SCOPE IS DEFENSIBLE	EVIDENCE STILL NEEDED
☐ Matter prototype		
☐ Practice pattern		
☐ Cross-practice candidate		
☐ Firm standard		
☐ Repair / hold / retire		

WORKFLOW PRECEDENT REVIEW

30-MINUTE REVIEW AGENDA

TIME	QUESTION	OWNER
0-4	What attorney or client-service outcome is constrained, and what changed since the last decision?	Practice sponsor
4-9	What is the actual workflow, and which sources and taxonomies make the AI useful?	Applied AI + KM
9-14	What authority stays with lawyers, and what access, privilege, or risk boundaries apply?	Matter owner + Risk / OGC / Security
14-19	What evaluation evidence exists, what failed, and what would make release unsafe?	Applied AI + technical owner
19-24	Are attorneys using it in real work? What corrections, workarounds, or abandonment signals matter?	Practice manager + users
24-28	What value is observable, and what adaptation or maintenance burden comes with broader reuse?	Director + practice leadership
28-30	Promote, limit, repair, hold, stop, or retire? Who owns the next evidence?	Named decision owner

DECISION RECORD

Decision

☐ Promote

☐ Limit

☐ Repair

☐ Hold

☐ Stop

☐ Retire

Scope

Eligible practice / matters / users / data / jurisdictions / duration:

Required authority

Named human review, release, override, and escalation:

Next evidence

Test, adoption, value, risk, knowledge, or support evidence needed:

Owners

Practice | Applied AI | KM | Technology | Risk / OGC | Adoption:

Revisit trigger

Date, model change, knowledge change, incident, adoption threshold, or new use case:

CROSS-PRACTICE TRANSFER CHECK

MUST BE RETESTED	SAME	DIFFERENT	ADAPTATION REQUIRED
Attorney task and client objective			
Knowledge sources and taxonomy			
Privilege, access, and data handling			
Human authority and escalation			
Evaluation and failure consequence			
Workflow insertion and adoption owner			
Value evidence and maintenance burden			

Rule: Reuse the controls and components that survive comparison. Do not export assumptions simply because the technology is portable.